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JERUSALEM INTERNATIONAL FELLOWS

Dear <<First Name>>,

It has been just over 3 months since our Fellows left Jerusalem. It seems both like a few days and a lifetime ago. I was in touch with our Fellows last week to find out what they are up to. You can see some great photos and links below. They came with these comments:

Vibha:

Indeed, the time is passing so quickly. But must say experience in Jerusalem left a huge impression on me both as a person and as an artist.

Anna:

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Here's the conclusion of the independent evaluation conducted by *On Track Consulting*:

The groundbreaking Jerusalem International Fellows (JIF) enriched the landscape of Jerusalem art and culture at a time when Jerusalemites were thirsty to break out of the culture of isolation generated by Covid and to conspire with leading artists from around the world.

The ten-weeks were filled with meaningful introductions, experiences, and creative collaborations. The nucleus was just four artists, each matched with a host organization. Together, they inspired many people in various disciplines across west and east Jerusalem.

As a pilot program launched in less than optimal time constraints, the program had a resounding impact already, and with a few tweaks and improvements, can easily become a permanent fixture in the Jerusalem community, with host organizations lined up to take part.

Scroll downs for some quotes from the 53 page evaluation by On Track Consulting. You can read the whole report [here](#).

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Vibha in Delhi with Jerusalem-based videographer Dan Robert Lahiani. They met at our Salon at [Artist Studios JLM](#). A great example of one of JIF's goals - facilitating international connections between artists that continue after the residency.

From Vibha:

During this time I am showing in few group shows:

<https://www.hamburger-kunsthalle.de/en/exhibitions/breathing>

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(editor's note: Vibha is part of two incredibly impressive groups of artists)



From Claudia:

"So many things have happened since we came back home from Jerusalem..."

After coming back a week ago from a Teaching period in Maine at the Bates Dance Festival, now I'm working on a new project as an homage to my father called "Luz Sonora" Celebrando a Mario Lavista, that will premier in October at the marvelous Teatro de la Ciudad in Mexico City and a few days later at the prestigious Festival Internacional Cervantino..."

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From Anna:

"I am in a research and rehearsal process for this performance that is working with yiddish primary sources. I'm working with jargon languages and the invisible inheritances of "dead" languages."

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From Sofia (pictured with students at Ibdaa school while we wait for a wedding photo):

"Lucas and I just got married and we are moving to NY."



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"The overwhelming number of significant relationships that were created by the artists, beyond those they made within their host organizations, far surpassed expectations."

From the artists:

ANNA:

"Overall, I made real friendships and got to understand Jerusalem on a very, very deep level-- which I think was the point. And was definitely achieved. This was an amazing life changing experience in many ways. I developed strong relations with people, and I will only begin to understand it once I've had time to digest it all."

VIBHA:

"Every residency has it's specificity. Here the orientation included engaging tours to understand some of the layers and complexities that make Jerusalem unique. I have never experienced such a strong religious culture experience. We delved into all the political, economic, and social layers in Israel, leaving room for us to pick and choose. Other residencies have the host organization explain the local scene from their own perspective. The Jerusalem Fellowship gives me more clarity. Here I think of politics as differences, which is a big change in my work."

CLAUDIA:

"They prepared us well... Then we were free to explore... like the 7 gates of the Old City. It was up to us to decide which doors we wished to enter and when...Jerusalem is a labyrinth. You need to be strong and find your way...I opened a window and found a garden. Now it will grow."

SOFIA:

"There was a shared sense of something important taking place...What we started at Ibdad needs to continue for the sake of humanity. It was really something special that has great potential to change perspectives and enrich the children's lives through art."

We will continue to upload photos, videos, and reflections from our Fellows. You can also enjoy photos and videos on our Instagram [@Jerusaleminternationalfellows](#).

All of the press we have received can be found

